

START HERE

# How to play

- 1 Find your child's color.
- 2 Pick a card, or let your child pick.
- 3 Play while it's fun. Stop before it isn't.
- 4 Try the talk tip. Then wait.

 **0–1** year

 **1–2** years

 **2–3** years

 **3–5** years



Every card: a grown-up plays along and stays within reach.

▲ 0–1 yr

01



## Peekaboo Cloth

NEEDS A dish towel

👤 From 4 mo

☰ Prep 0 min

💧 No mess

🕒 ~5 min

Hide your face behind the towel, then pop out: “Peekaboo!” Later, let baby pull it off your head.



TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT

Pause before “boo.” A kick, a grin or a squeal is baby’s turn.



**With a grown-up.** Put the towel away after play; never leave it in the crib.

▲ 0–1 yr

02



## Copy Cat Faces

NEEDS Just you

👤 From birth

☰ Prep 0 min

💧 No mess

🕒 ~3 min

Hold baby face to face, close enough to see you well. Open wide, smile big, stick out your tongue. Watch baby try it too.



TALK TIP · REPEAT AND ADD ONE

Copy baby's sounds back: "ba" becomes "ba-ba!" Then wait for another.



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

03



## Kitchen Drum

**NEEDS** A pot and a wooden spoon



From 6 mo



Prep 1 min



No mess



~5 min

Turn the pot upside down on the floor. Tap it, then hand baby the spoon. Take turns: soft, then loud.



**TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE**

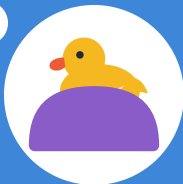
Name the sounds as they happen:  
“Bang! Bang! Soft... LOUD!”



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

04



## Where's Duck?

**NEEDS** A big toy and a towel

👤 From 6 mo

≡ Prep 1 min

💧 No mess

🕒 ~5 min

Hide the toy under the towel with a little bit showing. Ask “Where’s duck?” and let baby find it. Cheer!



**TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT**

Ask, then count to five in your head before you help.



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

05



# Bubble Watch

NEEDS Bubbles

👤 From 6 mo    ≡ Prep 1 min    💧 Low mess    ⌚ ~5 min

Blow a few bubbles slowly above baby. Let baby watch, reach and pop. Blow again when baby reaches, kicks or looks.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Use the same short words each time:  
“Up, up... pop!”



**With a grown-up.** You hold the bottle and blow away from baby's face. Wipe little hands.

▲ 0–1 yr

06



## Rock and Stop

NEEDS A song you know

👤 From birth

☰ Prep 0 min

💧 No mess

🕒 ~5 min

Hold baby and sway while you sing.  
Stop in the middle and wait. Start again  
when baby wiggles, coos or looks up.



TALK TIP · SING AND GESTURE

The pause is the game. Baby's wiggle means "more!"



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

07



## Roll It Back

**NEEDS** A big soft ball

👤 From 7 mo    ⌵ Prep 1 min    💧 No mess    ⌚ ~5 min

For babies who can sit: sit facing each other, legs apart. Roll the ball to baby, then help roll it back.



**TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT**

Say “Ready... roll!” and wait for a look, a sound or a reach.



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

08



## First Book Chat

**NEEDS** A board book

👤 From 3 mo

☰ Prep 0 min

💧 No mess

🕒 ~5 min

Sit baby on your lap. Point to one picture and name it. Let baby pat the pictures and help turn the pages.



**TALK TIP · FOLLOW THEIR LEAD**

Talk about whatever baby looks at, even the same page again.



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

09



## In and Out

**NEEDS** A basket and 4–5 big toys

👤 From 8 mo    ⌵ Prep 1 min    💧 Low mess    ⌚ ~5 min

Drop toys into the basket one by one:  
“In!” Tip them out: “Out!” Let baby dump  
and fill.



**TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE**

One word for each move: “in,” “out,” “all gone!”



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

10



## Leaf Hello

**NEEDS** A tree or a big plant

👤 From 3 mo    ≡ Prep 0 min    💧 No mess    ⌚ ~5 min

Carry baby close to a tree or a window plant. Touch a leaf together, look up at the sky, feel the breeze.



**TALK TIP · REPEAT AND ADD ONE**

Name it, then add one word: “Leaf.  
Green leaf. Soft leaf.”



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Leaves and petals stay out of mouths.

▲ 0–1 yr

11



# Tickle Countdown

NEEDS Just you



From 4 mo



Prep 0 min



No mess



~3 min

Wiggle your fingers in the air: “One... two... three...” then a gentle tickle. Do it again, a little slower.



TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT

Stop at “two...” A squeal or a kick asks for “three!”



**With a grown-up.** Gentle tickles only. If baby turns away, stop: that's a turn too.

▲ 0–1 yr

12



## Stack and Crash

**NEEDS** Plastic cups or big blocks

👤 From 6 mo    ⌵ Prep 1 min    💧 Low mess    ⌚ ~5 min

Stack three cups into a tower. Let baby knock it over. Cheer, and build it again together.



**TALK TIP · SING AND GESTURE**

Say “up, up, up... crash!” and throw your arms wide on “crash.”



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

▲ 0–1 yr

13



## Sock Off!

**NEEDS** A clean grown-up sock

👤 From 6 mo    ≡ Prep 0 min    💧 No mess    ⌚ ~3 min

Slip a big, loose sock halfway onto baby's foot. Let baby pull it off: "Sock off!" Try the other foot.



**TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE**

Say it as it happens: "Foot! Sock on... sock off!"



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Put the sock away after play; socks stay out of mouths.

1–2 yrs

14



## Box Car

**NEEDS** A big cardboard box

 From 12 mo    Prep 3 min    No mess    ~10 min

Your toddler sits in the box. Push it slowly around the room. Stop at “stations” to wave hello.



**TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT**

Say “Ready, set...” and wait for “go!”  
Any sound counts.



**With a grown-up.** Push slowly on the floor. Pull out staples and tape first.

1–2 yrs

15



## Stir the Soup

**NEEDS** A pot, a big spoon, big blocks

 From 12 mo  Prep 1 min  Low mess  ~10 min

Drop blocks into the pot and stir. Blow on the “hot” soup. Serve a spoonful to a teddy.



**TALK TIP · OFFER A CHOICE**

Ask “Hot soup or cold soup?” Hold up two hands and wait.



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

16



## Animal Voices

**NEEDS** Big toy animals or a picture book

 From 12 mo

 Prep 1 min

 No mess

 ~5 min

Hold up an animal and make its sound.  
Pass it to your child. Swap animals and  
go again.



**TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT**

Say “The cow says...” and leave a gap  
for “moo.”



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item  
bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

17



## Pour and Splash

**NEEDS** A tub of water, 2 plastic cups

 From 12 mo

 Prep 3 min

 Messy

 ~10 min

Set the tub on a towel. Pour water from cup to cup. Let your child pour, splash and fill.



**TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE**

Talk as it happens: “Full... empty! Pour, pour.”



**With a grown-up.** Water play: a grown-up within arm’s reach the whole time. Tip the water out after.

1–2 yrs

18



## Block Tower

NEEDS Big blocks

From 14 mo Prep 1 min Low mess ~5 min

Build a tower together, one block each.  
Count as you go. Let them knock it down  
and start again.



TALK TIP · REPEAT AND ADD ONE

They say “block,” you say “big block!”



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

19



## Hat Parade

**NEEDS** 3–4 hats from around the house

 From 12 mo

 Prep 2 min

 No mess

 ~5 min

Try on hats in front of a mirror. Make a silly face in each one. March around the room.



**TALK TIP · OFFER A CHOICE**

Ask “Sun hat or winter hat?” Let them choose yours too.



**With a grown-up.** Only hats with no ties, cords or pom-poms. Stay within reach.

1–2 yrs

20



# Pillow Mountain

NEEDS Couch cushions

 From 12 mo    Prep 2 min    Low mess    ~10 min

Pile the cushions on the floor to make a mountain. Help your child climb up, then slide down.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Say it as they move: “Up, up, up! Down!”



**With a grown-up.** On the floor, away from furniture corners. Stay within reach.

1–2 yrs

21



## Sock Toss

**NEEDS** Rolled-up pairs of socks, a basket

 From 15 mo    Prep 1 min    Low mess    ~5 min

Toss the sock balls into the basket. Find a big one and a little one. Balance one on your head!



**TALK TIP · REPEAT AND ADD ONE**  
“Sock” becomes “big sock!” or “red sock!”



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

22



## Teddy's Bedtime

**NEEDS** A stuffed toy, a small towel

 From 15 mo    Prep 0 min    No mess    ~5 min

Tuck teddy in with the towel. Read teddy a book, sing teddy a song, whisper “night-night.”



**TALK TIP · FOLLOW THEIR LEAD**

If they feed teddy instead, talk about the snack.



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

23



## Chair Tunnel

**NEEDS** Two chairs and a blanket

 From 12 mo    Prep 3 min    No mess    ~10 min

Drape the blanket over two chairs to make a tunnel. Crawl through together, then take turns.



**TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE**

Say the word as they move: “In... through... out!”



**With a grown-up.** Use sturdy chairs that won't tip. Stay within reach.

1–2 yrs

24



## Clap and Stomp

NEEDS Just you



From 12 mo



Prep 0 min



No mess



~3 min

Clap twice, stomp twice, pat your knees.  
Let your child copy you, then you copy  
their moves.



TALK TIP · FOLLOW THEIR LEAD

Copy whatever they do. They're the  
leader now.



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item  
bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

1–2 yrs

25



## Pull-Out Box

**NEEDS** An empty tissue box, 6 washcloths

 From 12 mo    Prep 2 min    Low mess    ~5 min

Stuff the washcloths into the box. Your child pulls them out one by one. Stuff them back in and go again.



**TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT**

Hold one up: “More?” Wait for a look, a point or a sound.



**With a grown-up.** Pull out the plastic film from the box opening first. Stay within reach.

1–2 yrs

26



## Kick and Chase

**NEEDS** A big soft ball

 From 15 mo    Prep 0 min    No mess    ~10 min

Roll or kick the ball across the room.  
Race to it together. Catch it and sit on it!



**TALK TIP · OFFER A CHOICE**

Ask “Kick it or roll it?” Show both, then wait.



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

27



## Blanket Fort

**NEEDS** A blanket, chairs, pillows

 From 24 mo    Prep 5 min    Low mess    ~15 min

Build a fort together. Bring in a book and a teddy. Read inside, then peek out the door.



**TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE**

Use place words: “in,” “under,” “on top,” “behind.”



**With a grown-up.** Sturdy chairs only; nothing heavy on top. Stay within reach.

★ 2–3 yrs

28



## Tea Party

**NEEDS** Plastic cups and plates, stuffed toys

🕒 From 24 mo    ≡ Prep 2 min    💧 No mess    ⌚ ~10 min

Set a pretend table for the toys. Pour pretend tea, pass pretend cake, and clink cups: “Cheers!”



**TALK TIP · OFFER A CHOICE**

Ask as Bear: “More tea? Milk or honey?”  
Wait for the answer.



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

29



## Color Sort

**NEEDS** Big blocks in 3 colors, 3 bowls

 From 26 mo    Prep 2 min    Low mess    ~10 min

Put one of each color in a bowl. Your child sorts the rest. Mix them all up and sort again.



**TALK TIP** · REPEAT AND ADD ONE

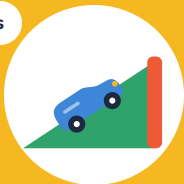
“Red” becomes “red block goes here!”



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

30



## Car Ramp

**NEEDS** A board or big book, big toy cars

👤 From 24 mo    ≡ Prep 2 min    💧 No mess    ⌚ ~10 min

Prop the board on the sofa to make a ramp. Race the cars down. Which one goes the farthest?



**TALK TIP** · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Say what happens: “Fast! Slow! Crash!”



**With a grown-up.** Only cars bigger than a toilet-paper tube, with no loose wheels.

★ 2–3 yrs

31



## Big Paper Art

**NEEDS** Big paper, jumbo egg-shaped crayons, tape

From 24 mo   Prep 2 min   Low mess   ~10 min

Tape the paper to the floor. Draw lines, dots and circles side by side. Swap crayons now and then.



**TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE**

**Describe, don't quiz: "Round and round. A big circle!"**



**With a grown-up.** Crayons too big to fit in a toilet-paper tube. Toss broken bits.

★ 2–3 yrs

32



## Freeze Dance

**NEEDS** A song to sing or play

 From 24 mo    Prep 0 min    No mess    ~5 min

Dance to a song. When the music stops, freeze! Take turns being the one who stops the music.



**TALK TIP · FOLLOW THEIR LEAD**

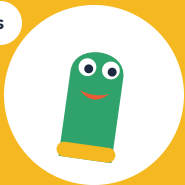
Let your child shout “stop!” and “go!” for you.



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

33



## Sock Friend Chat

**NEEDS** A clean grown-up sock, a marker (yours)

 From 24 mo    Prep 2 min    No mess    ~5 min

Draw eyes on the sock and slip it on your hand. Your sock friend says hello, asks a question, then waits.



**TALK TIP · PAUSE AND WAIT**

**Sock friends are patient. Give extra time to answer.**



**With a grown-up.** Draw the face on: no buttons or stick-on eyes. You keep the marker.

★ 2–3 yrs

34



## Nature Basket

**NEEDS** A basket, a walk outside

 From 24 mo    Prep 0 min    Low mess    ~15 min

Collect big leaves, sticks and pinecones.  
At home, sort them: bumpy, smooth, big, small.



**TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE**

Name how they feel: “Bumpy pinecone.  
Smooth stick.”



**With a grown-up.** Only things bigger than a toilet-paper tube. No berries or mushrooms. Wash hands after.

★ 2–3 yrs

35



## Pretend Shop

**NEEDS** Empty food boxes, a bag

👤 From 26 mo    ≡ Prep 3 min    💧 Low mess    ⌚ ~15 min

Set up a shop on the sofa. Your child fills the bag and pays you with a high five. Then swap jobs.



**TALK TIP · OFFER A CHOICE**

Ask “Cereal or crackers today?” and wait.



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

36



## Toy Bath

**NEEDS** A tub of water, a washable toy, a cloth

 From 24 mo    Prep 3 min    Messy    ~10 min

Give the toy a bath: wash its hands, feet and tummy. Dry it off and tuck it in.



**TALK TIP** · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Name body parts: “Wash the toes. Now the knees!”



**With a grown-up.** Water play: a grown-up within arm’s reach the whole time. Tip the water out after.

★ 2–3 yrs

37



## Animal Moves

**NEEDS** Space to move

👤 From 24 mo    ≡ Prep 0 min    💧 No mess    ⌚ ~5 min

Hop like a frog, stomp like an elephant, tiptoe like a cat. Take turns picking the animal.



**TALK TIP · SING AND GESTURE**

Add the sound and the move: “Hop, hop, ribbit!”



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

38



# Shape Hunt

NEEDS Just you

 From 30 mo    Prep 0 min    No mess    ~10 min

Walk around the house looking for circles: a plate, a clock, a wheel. Then hunt for squares.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

Point and name: “Round, like the clock!”



**With a grown-up.** Stay within reach. Every item bigger than a toilet-paper tube.

★ 2–3 yrs

39



## Little Helper

**NEEDS** A cloth damp with plain water

👤 From 24 mo    ≡ Prep 1 min    💧 Low mess    ⌚ ~5 min

Wipe the table together after a meal.  
Then let your child wipe a chair, then a toy.



**TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE**

Talk as you work: “Wipe, wipe. All clean!”



**With a grown-up.** Plain water only: no sprays or wipes. Stay within reach.

● 3–5 yrs

40



## Story Box

**NEEDS** A box, 3 toys from around the house

 From 36 mo    Prep 2 min    No mess    ~10 min

Pull out 3 toys. Make up a story that uses all three. Take turns adding one sentence each.



**TALK TIP · FOLLOW THEIR LEAD**

Let the story go anywhere. Ask, “And then what?”



**With a grown-up.** A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

41



## Obstacle Course

NEEDS Pillows, a chair, a blanket

👤 From 36 mo    ≡ Prep 5 min    💧 Low mess    ⌚ ~15 min

Build a course: crawl under the chair, hop over the pillows, roll across the blanket.



TALK TIP · TAKE TURNS

Give two-step directions: “Crawl under, then jump!” Then swap.



**With a grown-up.** Clear the space of sharp corners. A grown-up stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

42



# I Spy Colors

NEEDS Just you



From 36 mo



Prep 0 min



No mess



~5 min

“I spy something green.” Your child guesses. Then they pick something and give you the clue.



TALK TIP · TAKE TURNS

If they get stuck, add a hint: “It’s round...”



**With a grown-up.** A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

43



## Restaurant

**NEEDS** Paper, crayons, plates

 From 36 mo    Prep 5 min    Low mess    ~15 min

Draw a menu together. Your child takes your order, “cooks” it and brings it to the table. Swap roles.



**TALK TIP** · OFFER A CHOICE

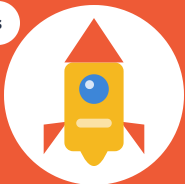
Ask “Soup or pizza? Anything else?”



**With a grown-up.** A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

44



## Box Rocket

**NEEDS** A big box, crayons

👤 From 36 mo    ≡ Prep 5 min    💧 Low mess    ⌚ ~15 min

Draw buttons and windows on the box.  
Climb in, count down from ten, and blast  
off to the moon.



**TALK TIP · FOLLOW THEIR LEAD**

Ask “Where are we flying? What’s out  
the window?”



**With a grown-up.** Pull out staples and tape first.  
A grown-up stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

45



## Kitchen List

NEEDS Paper, a crayon

👤 From 42 mo    ≡ Prep 2 min    💧 No mess    ⌚ ~10 min

Draw a list together: an apple, a cup, a spoon. Hunt for each one in the kitchen and check it off.



TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

“Found the spoon! What’s next on our list?”



**With a grown-up.** You choose the list. Knives, the stove and cleaners stay off it.

● 3–5 yrs

46



## Do What I Do

NEEDS Just you

👤 From 36 mo    ≡ Prep 0 min    💧 No mess    ⌚ ~5 min

Touch your nose, hop on one foot, spin around once. Your child copies. Then they're the leader.



**TALK TIP · TAKE TURNS**

Being the leader means practicing clear directions.



**With a grown-up.** A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

47



## Shadow Animals

**NEEDS** A flashlight, a wall

 From 36 mo    Prep 2 min    No mess    ~10 min

Dim the lights. Shine the flashlight on a wall and make hand shadows: a bird, a dog, a crocodile.



**TALK TIP** · PAUSE AND WAIT

Ask “What animal is this?” Let them guess, then try a new one.



**With a grown-up.** A grown-up holds the flashlight. Battery covers stay shut.

● 3–5 yrs

48



## Book Bridge

**NEEDS** Books or blocks, toy cars

👤 From 36 mo    ≡ Prep 3 min    💧 Low mess    ⌚ ~10 min

Build a bridge between two stacks. Drive cars over it. Make it longer. Will it hold?



**TALK TIP · WONDER ALOUD**

Say “I wonder if it will hold?” Then wait and see.



**With a grown-up.** A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

49



## Sock Match

**NEEDS** A pile of clean socks

 From 36 mo    Prep 1 min    Low mess    ~10 min

Dump the socks out. Race to find matching pairs. Roll each pair into a ball.



**TALK TIP** · OFFER A CHOICE

Hold up two: “Same or different?”



**With a grown-up.** A grown-up plays along and stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

50



## Water Painting

**NEEDS** A cup of water, a paintbrush

👤 From 36 mo    ⌵ Prep 2 min    💧 Low mess    ⌚ ~15 min

Outside, “paint” a fence, a step or the sidewalk with water. Watch the picture dry and disappear.



**TALK TIP · WONDER ALOUD**

“Where did it go? I wonder if the sun dried it.”



**With a grown-up.** Water play: a grown-up within arm's reach, away from the street.

● 3–5 yrs

51



## Feelings Faces

**NEEDS** A wall mirror or an unbreakable one

👤 From 36 mo    ≡ Prep 0 min    💧 No mess    ⌚ ~5 min

Make faces in the mirror together: happy, sad, surprised, grumpy. Guess each other's face.



**TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE**

**“Your eyebrows went up. Surprised!”**  
Ask when they felt that way.



**With a grown-up.** Use a wall mirror or an unbreakable one. A grown-up stays nearby.

● 3–5 yrs

52



## Sound Walk

**NEEDS** A walk outside

👤 From 36 mo    ≡ Prep 0 min    💧 No mess    ⌚ ~15 min

Stand still and listen. Count sounds on your fingers: a bird, a car, the wind. Walk on and listen again.



**TALK TIP · TAKE TURNS**

Whisper “What do you hear?” Take turns naming sounds.



**With a grown-up.** Hold hands near the street. A grown-up stays close.

MAKE IT YOURS



# Your own play

TITLE

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NEEDS

---

THE PLAY

---

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TALK TIP

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Ages:

0-1

1-2

2-3

3-5